

Olympiad Test Paper — Sanskrit (Class 7) — Paper 4

Chapter 8: हितं मनोहारि च दुर्लभं वचः (Hitam Manohari cha Durlabham Vachah)

Paper 4 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Sanskrit (NCERT Class 7, Deepakam)
Chapter	8 — हितं मनोहारि च दुर्लभं वचः (Hitam Manohari cha Durlabham Vachah)
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. National-Olympiad traps: च joins हितम् with मनोहारि as a logical conjunction ('both...and'), so it raises the bar — it never weakens it to a disjunctive 'or' (वा); दुर्लभम् ('dur-' = difficulty, not absolute negation) is the contradictory of सुलभम् yet only the contrary, not the negation, of अशक्यम् — rare-but-attainable, never impossible; all three of हितम्, मनोहारि, दुर्लभम् are neuter-singular adjectives agreeing with the neuter noun वचः (नपुंसकलिङ्ग, एकवचन), not nouns in apposition or indeclinables; मनोहारि resolves by sandhi as मनः + हारि (visarga → 'o' before a voiced sound) = 'heart-stealing', not 'mind-harming'; विद्या is gathered क्षणशः (units of TIME) while अर्थः is gathered कणशः (physical UNITS) — the -शस् suffix builds gender-indifferent distributive adverbs, never datives, and the two never swap; a क्रियावान् (कृ → क्रिया + possessive -वत्/-वान्) embodies कर्म over the विकृत्यन's कथन; सूक्तिः (सु+उक्ति, like सुभाषितम्) merely resembles सूक्ष्म ('subtle', no उक्ति); and through every counsel शीलम् remains the deepest value. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. Treat the verse as a logical claim: 'rare is speech that is हितम् AND मनोहारि.' If we model speech by two independent properties (useful: yes/no; pleasing: yes/no), the verse asserts rarity for exactly which of the four resulting categories?

- (A) All four categories equally, since speech in general is rare
- (B) The two categories where AT LEAST ONE property is 'yes'
- (C) The single category where both properties are 'no'
- (D) The single category where BOTH properties are simultaneously 'yes'

2. Suppose च in हितं मनोहारि च were replaced by वा. Using the truth-table picture (useful?/pleasing?), the standard for 'qualifying' speech would change from requiring how many properties to requiring how many?

- (A) From requiring at least one to requiring both — the standard would rise
- (B) From requiring BOTH properties together to requiring only AT LEAST ONE
- (C) From requiring both to requiring neither — the standard would vanish
- (D) It would not change the count of required properties at all

3. A student argues that the three words हितम्, मनोहारि and दुर्लभम् are three separate nouns naming three separate things the verse praises. The grammatical fault in this reading is that the words are actually:

- (A) Three finite verbs governing वचः as their object
- (B) Three indeclinable adverbs modifying an unstated verb
- (C) Adjectives, all agreeing with the single neuter noun वचः and describing it, not three independent nouns
- (D) Three nouns in the genitive depending on वचः

4. Since हितम्, मनोहारि and दुर्लभम् all qualify वचः, and वचः is neuter singular, what does this force about the three qualifier-forms — and what would change if वचः were instead replaced by a masculine noun like अर्थः?

- (A) They must stand in neuter singular to match वचः; with a masculine अर्थः they would take masculine forms instead
- (B) They stay in a fixed neuter form regardless of the noun, since adjectives never change with the noun
- (C) They must be plural because there are three of them, whatever the noun's number
- (D) They would become adverbs and stop agreeing once the noun changed gender

5. Consider four utterances. (i) A true, kind correction that helps. (ii) A sweet lie that pleases. (iii) A true, harsh rebuke that helps but stings. (iv) Silence. Ranking them by how fully each satisfies the verse's BOTH-AND ideal, which alone fully meets it?

- (A) (ii), because pleasing speech is what the verse prizes most
- (B) (iii), because beneficial speech alone fulfils the verse
- (C) (iv), because saying nothing avoids all harm
- (D) Only (i), since it is at once beneficial and pleasing

6. The verse calls the both-and speech दुर्लभम् rather than अशक्यम्. Mapping this to a 'frequency' scale running from सुलभम् (easy/common) through दुर्लभम् to अशक्यम् (impossible), the verse places ideal speech:

- (A) Near the hard-but-attainable end — past common, but stopping short of impossible
- (B) At the सुलभम् end, since good speech is everywhere
- (C) At the अशक्यम् end, since such speech can never occur
- (D) Outside the scale entirely, since frequency does not apply to speech

7. दुर्लभम् and सुलभम् share -लभम् ('to be obtained') but carry opposite prefixes दुर्- and सु-. Treating these as a contradictory pair, the precise relation of दुर्लभम् to अशक्यम् ('impossible') is that दुर्लभम् is:

- (A) Exactly synonymous with अशक्यम्, since both are negative-prefixed
- (B) The opposite of अशक्यम्, meaning the same as सुलभम्
- (C) Merely the contrary of 'easy' (hard to obtain), which is weaker than the flat negation 'impossible' that अशक्यम् expresses
- (D) Stronger than अशक्यम्, meaning 'more than impossible'

8. A motivational banner reads: 'विद्या is दुर्लभा — so never stop studying.' Why is this use of दुर्लभ logically coherent, whereas swapping in अशक्यम् would make the banner self-defeating?

- (A) Both words work equally, since both simply mean 'difficult'
- (B) दुर्लभ means common, so studying is needed only because everyone does it
- (C) दुर्लभ implies rare-yet-reachable, which rewards effort; अशक्यम् would assert it can never be reached, contradicting the call to keep trying
- (D) अशक्यम् would be better, since impossible goals best motivate effort

9. मनोहारि is the sandhi-product of two parts. Resolving it correctly and identifying the sandhi at the seam:

- (A) मनः + हारि, where the visarga of मनः becomes 'o' before the voiced sound, giving मनो-
- (B) मन + अहारि, where 'a + a' merges to long 'ā', meaning 'not-stealing'
- (C) मनः + आहारि, where visarga drops and 'a' lengthens, meaning 'mind-feeding'
- (D) मनस् + हारि with no sound change, since मनस् never alters before हारि

10. Given मनोहारि = मनः ('heart/mind') + हारि ('stealing, captivating'), the literal force of the compound and the kind of appeal it names are:

- (A) 'Mind-harming' — it injures, hence describes speech that is harsh
- (B) 'Mind-bearing' — it instructs, hence describes speech that is merely useful
- (C) 'Heart-stealing' — it captivates, hence describes speech that is pleasing
- (D) 'Heart-hiding' — it conceals, hence describes speech that is subtle

11. हितम् and मनोहारि are made to refer to different faculties of the listener. The cleanest abstraction is that हितम् answers 'does it help my ____?' while मनोहारि answers 'does it win my ____?', filling the blanks respectively with:

- (A) heart / feeling — and — welfare / good
- (B) wealth — and — wealth
- (C) curiosity — and — character
- (D) welfare / good — and — heart / feeling

12. Vocabulary contrast: in the family हित / प्रिय / सत्य / अनृत, which single pairing correctly matches a word to its sense?

- (A) हित = pleasing, प्रिय = beneficial
- (B) सत्य = true, अनृत = false/untrue
- (C) सत्य = pleasing, अनृत = beneficial
- (D) प्रिय = true, हित = false

- 13.** A classical maxim runs सत्यं ब्रूयात् प्रियं ब्रूयात् ('speak the true, speak the pleasing'). प्रियम् in such advice is closest in role to which word of our verse, and why?
- (A) हितम्, because प्रियम् and 'beneficial' both denote usefulness
 - (B) मनोहारि, because both name the pleasing/agreeable quality of speech
 - (C) दुर्लभम्, because प्रियम् means 'rare' like दुर्लभम्
 - (D) वचः, because प्रियम् is just another word for 'speech'
- 14.** Why is the enclitic च written separately after मनोहारि (मनोहारि च) instead of being fused to the preceding word, even though Sanskrit often merges adjacent sounds?
- (A) च is a verb, and verbs are never written joined to other words
 - (B) मनोहारि ends in a consonant, which forbids any sandhi with च
 - (C) च begins with a consonant, so there is no vowel-meets-vowel junction to trigger a vowel-sandhi merger; the enclitic stays as a separate 'च'
 - (D) च is emphatic here and emphatic particles always resist sandhi
- 15.** In हितं मनोहारि च, the postposed च conventionally links which items, illustrating the Sanskrit rule that an enclitic च joins the word it follows to what precedes?
- (A) It joins वचः to दुर्लभम्, the last two words of the line
 - (B) It joins मनोहारि (which it follows) to हितम् (which precedes) — 'useful and pleasing'
 - (C) It joins only the word after it, leaving हितम् ungrouped
 - (D) It joins nothing; a postposed च is purely decorative
- 16.** Sanskrit keeps 'and', 'or' and the interrogative 'what/which' distinct. If a verse used वा where our verse uses च, the meaning of the speech-standard would shift because वा means:
- (A) 'and' — leaving the both-and standard unchanged
 - (B) 'or' — turning the demanded 'useful AND pleasing' into the looser 'useful OR pleasing'
 - (C) 'what/which' — turning the line into a question about speech
 - (D) 'not' — negating the qualities of speech
- 17.** Read the line as a hidden conditional: 'IF speech is both useful and pleasing, THEN it is rare.' On this reading, observing a piece of speech that is rare lets you conclude:
- (A) That the speech must be both useful and pleasing, since the two are equivalent
 - (B) Nothing certain about its being both useful and pleasing — rarity is the consequence, not the cause, so it cannot be run backwards
 - (C) That the speech is neither useful nor pleasing, since rare things lack qualities
 - (D) That the speech is common, contradicting the premise
- 18.** A pupil says: 'Because the verse calls वचः दुर्लभम्, ALL speech is rare.' Diagnose the scope error precisely.
- (A) There is no error; the verse does call all speech rare
 - (B) The error is in दुर्लभम्, which actually means 'all'

(C) दुर्लभम् is restricted by the adjectives हितम् and मनोहारि — only speech that is both is called rare, not speech in general

(D) The error is that वचः means 'some speech', so only some speech is meant arbitrarily

19. Suppose two manuscripts differ: one reads हितं मनोहारि च दुर्लभं वचः, the other हितं मनोहारि वा सुलभं वचः. Compared with the original, the variant manuscript would make ideal speech:

(A) Both easier to qualify (only one quality needed) and easier to find (common, not rare) — a doubly weakened claim

(B) Harder on both counts, demanding both qualities and greater rarity

(C) Unchanged, since वा/च and सुलभ/दुर्लभ are synonyms

(D) Harder to qualify but easier to find, mixing the two effects

20. If one keeps हितम् but exchanges मनोहारि for its opposite, the resulting speech and its standing relative to the verse's ideal would be:

(A) Pleasing but useless — and so exactly the ideal

(B) Both useful and pleasing — the ideal itself, unchanged

(C) Neither useful nor pleasing — but still the ideal by default

(D) Useful but unpleasant — and therefore NOT the rare both-and ideal the verse praises

21. क्षणशः and कणशः are built on क्षण ('moment') and कण ('grain/particle') with the suffix -शस्. The grammatical category this suffix produces, and what stays fixed about the result, are:

(A) A dative noun ('for the moment / for the grain') that declines like the base noun

(B) An adjective that must agree in gender and number with the noun it describes

(C) A finite verb that conjugates for person and number

(D) A distributive adverb ('unit by unit') that is indeclinable — its form does not change for any gender, number or case

22. The verse pairs विद्या with क्षणशः and अर्थः with कणशः. The deepest reason this pairing is apt (and not arbitrarily swappable) is that:

(A) Knowledge is a kind of grain and wealth is a kind of time, so the words simply match their nouns' substance

(B) Knowledge accrues through units of TIME spent (moments of study), while wealth accrues through small physical UNITS (grains/coins) saved

(C) The pairing is arbitrary and the adverbs may be freely swapped without loss

(D) Both are gathered the same way, and the two adverbs mean exactly the same thing

23. By analogy with क्षणशः and कणशः, a new saying 'जलं बिन्दुशः वर्धते' ('water grows drop by drop') would form बिन्दुशः by the same pattern. That pattern is:

(A) noun + case-ending → a dative meaning 'for the drop'

(B) verb-root + suffix → a finite verb meaning 'it drips'

- (C) noun (बिन्दु, 'drop') + -शस् → an indeclinable 'drop by drop' distributive adverb
 (D) adjective + ending → a word agreeing with जलम् in gender

24. A child studies attentively for fifteen minutes every single day across a whole year. Which verse-adverb most precisely captures how his knowledge grew, and on what ground?

- (A) कणशः — because knowledge is counted out in physical grains
 (B) all at once — because a year's study counts as a single event
 (C) neither, since adverbs cannot describe how knowledge grows
 (D) क्षणशः — because learning accumulated through repeated small units of time (moments of study)

25. क्रियावान् is क्रिया ('action') + the possessive suffix -वत्/-वान्, and क्रिया itself traces to the verbal root कृ ('to do/make'). Chaining these two facts, क्रियावान् most fundamentally praises:

- (A) One who lacks action — i.e. who stays idle
 (B) One who possesses action — i.e. who actually does and performs deeds
 (C) One who only describes action eloquently — i.e. a skilled talker about deeds
 (D) One who opposes action — i.e. who prevents others from acting

26. The chapter sets the क्रियावान् against the विकृत्यन. Abstracting the contrast to a single principle, it endorses:

- (A) कथन (talk) over कर्म (deeds) — let eloquence outweigh action
 (B) अर्थ (wealth) over विद्या (knowledge)
 (C) कर्म (deeds) over mere कथन (talk) — let action outweigh boasting
 (D) silence over both speech and deeds

27. Two students hand in a science project. The first quietly submits thorough, finished work and says little; the second loudly announces, before finishing, how brilliant his project will be. By the chapter's values, the correct labelling is:

- (A) The quiet finisher is the praiseworthy क्रियावान्; the loud announcer is the criticised विकृत्यन
 (B) The loud announcer is the क्रियावान् because he spoke confidently about the work
 (C) Both are विकृत्यन because both produced projects
 (D) Both are क्रियावान् because both described their work aloud

28. How does the chapter's praise of the क्रियावान् reinforce, rather than contradict, the speech-verse's call for हितम्-मनोहारि speech?

- (A) They contradict: the speech-verse prizes talk, while the doer-praise rejects all speech
 (B) They are unrelated: one concerns grammar, the other concerns money
 (C) Both subordinate empty display to real worth: speech should genuinely benefit and please, and a person should genuinely act rather than merely boast
 (D) They agree only in that both recommend complete silence

29. सूक्तिः arises from sandhi of सु ('well/good') + उक्तिः ('saying'). The vowel junction सु + उ resolves as:

- (A) उ + उ producing the diphthong औ, giving सोक्तिः
- (B) Like vowels उ + उ combining into a long ऊ, giving सू- and hence सूक्तिः
- (C) उ + उ producing the semivowel वृ, giving स्वक्तिः
- (D) No change, leaving a vowel gap as सु उक्तिः

30. सूक्तिः and सूक्ष्म both begin with the sound सू yet differ in meaning. The reliable way to keep them apart, based on their make-up, is:

- (A) Both contain उक्ति, so both relate to speech
- (B) सूक्ष्म contains उक्ति, so it means a refined saying
- (C) सूक्तिः contains उक्ति ('saying'), so it is a GOOD SAYING; सूक्ष्म has no उक्ति and means SUBTLE/fine
- (D) The shared सू- makes them exact synonyms

31. सूक्तिः is treated as equivalent to सुभाषितम्. Analysing सुभाषितम् the same way as सूक्तिः, it breaks into:

- (A) सु ('six') + भाषितम् ('faults') = 'six faults'
- (B) सुभा ('light') + षितम् ('hidden') = 'hidden light'
- (C) सुभाष (a proper name) + इतम् = a personal name only
- (D) सु ('well') + भाषितम् ('spoken') = 'that which is well-spoken'

32. कुतूहलम् is glossed as कौतुकम् and is a close cousin of जिज्ञासा from Chapter 1. जिज्ञासा is a desiderative of the root ज्ञा ('to know'), literally 'the wish to know'. The common thread the chapter prizes in all three is:

- (A) Eagerness to boast — the talker's pride
- (B) Eagerness to know — the learner's curiosity that drives the gathering of knowledge
- (C) Eagerness to rest — the idle person's wish
- (D) Eagerness for wealth — the merchant's greed

33. भाण्डागारः ('treasure-trove / storehouse') is used in the chapter as a metaphor for knowledge. Why is it an especially fitting image for knowledge gathered क्षणशः?

- (A) A storehouse fills item by item over time, mirroring how knowledge accumulates moment by moment
- (B) A storehouse fills instantly in one stroke, like a sudden flash of knowledge
- (C) A storehouse holds only coins, never knowledge, making the metaphor ironic
- (D) A storehouse is always empty, like a boaster's claims

34. Through all its counsel on speech, effort and curiosity, the chapter keeps returning to शीलम् as the deepest measure. A person who speaks beautifully, gives useful advice and is wealthy, yet is dishonest, by the chapter's standard still lacks:

- (A) शीलम् (good character), which outweighs eloquence and wealth
- (B) वचः (the power of speech), since he already speaks well

(C) कुतूहलम् (curiosity), which has nothing to do with his case

(D) भाण्डागारः (a treasure-store), since he is already wealthy

35. Reading the speech-verse and the क्षणशः-कणशः verse together yields a single shared moral about worthwhile things. That moral is best stated as:

(A) They are easy and instantly obtained, so no effort is needed

(B) They are rare/hard yet attainable through patient, sustained, incremental effort

(C) They are truly impossible and so not worth pursuing

(D) They are gained mainly by loud and frequent boasting

36. A debater claims: 'दुर्लभम् and अशक्यम् are interchangeable, so the verse means ideal speech can never exist.' The single best refutation is that:

(A) दुर्लभम् ('hard to obtain') asserts rarity, not impossibility, so the verse leaves ideal speech attainable — it does not equal अशक्यम्

(B) दुर्लभम् really does mean impossible, so the debater is right

(C) अशक्यम् means 'rare', so the two only seem different

(D) The verse uses neither word, so the comparison is moot

37. Consider the rule that an adjective inherits the noun's gender. Given वचः is neuter, which inflected form would be the correct neuter-singular agreement for 'beneficial' qualifying it — and which mismatched options must be rejected?

(A) हितः is correct because adjectives default to masculine

(B) हिता is correct because abstract qualities are feminine

(C) हितानि is correct because three qualities require a plural

(D) हितम् is correct (neuter singular); the masculine हितः and feminine हिता would mismatch वचः

38. वचः belongs to the neuter -स् stem type (like मनः, तेजः, यशः). Reasoning from this stem class, which statement about वचः is correct?

(A) It is a feminine -आ stem, declining like a noun in -ā

(B) Its underlying stem ends in -स्, surfacing as visarga (वचः) in the nominative/accusative singular — like मनः from मनस्

(C) It is a masculine -अ stem, taking the ending -ः like देवः for masculine reasons

(D) It is an indeclinable with no stem and no case forms at all

39. The same -स् stem behaviour links वचः and मनः. This shared feature most directly explains which other word of the lesson?

(A) क्रियावान्, whose -वान् is an -स् stem like वचः

(B) दुर्लभम्, whose दुर्- prefix is a neuter -स् stem

(C) मनोहारि, whose first member मनः shows the very same -स्/visarga-to-'o' behaviour before a voiced sound

(D) क्षणशः, whose final -शः is the same neuter -स् stem ending

40. If a teacher writes a सूक्तिः on the board, what should students reasonably expect to see, given the word's make-up?

- (A) A boast about the teacher's own greatness
- (B) An inventory of the school's stored treasures
- (C) A brief, well-phrased wise saying worth remembering
- (D) A subtle riddle deliberately left without meaning

41. A child constantly asks 'why?', seeks out books to find answers, and tries small experiments. Which chapter virtue does she most clearly display, and which mislabel must be rejected?

- (A) कुतूहलम् (curiosity); she is NOT a विकृत्यन merely because she asks aloud
- (B) विकृत्यन (boasting), because she speaks her questions aloud
- (C) अशक्यम् (impossibility), because her questions cannot be answered
- (D) भाण्डागारः (a treasure-store), because she collects books

42. Which single set of four word-meanings is entirely correct?

- (A) दुर्लभम् = impossible; च = or; क्रियावान् = boaster; सूक्तिः = subtle
- (B) दुर्लभम् = rare; च = and; क्रियावान् = doer; सूक्तिः = good saying
- (C) दुर्लभम् = common; च = and; क्रियावान् = doer; सूक्तिः = subtle
- (D) दुर्लभम् = rare; च = or; क्रियावान् = boaster; सूक्तिः = good saying

43. Which adverb–noun assignment from the verse is the ONLY fully correct one?

- (A) विद्या grows कणशः; अर्थः grows क्षणशः (B) Both विद्या and अर्थः grow क्षणशः
- (C) विद्या grows क्षणशः (moment by moment); अर्थः grows कणशः (particle by particle)
- (D) Both विद्या and अर्थः grow कणशः

44. A student offers this composite reading: 'च = or; दुर्लभम् = impossible; क्रियावान् = a great talker; क्षणशः and कणशः both mean all-at-once.' How many of these four claims are wrong?

- (A) All four are wrong
- (B) Only the च claim is wrong
- (C) Exactly two are wrong
- (D) None is wrong; all four are correct

45. Across the chapter, the words सूक्तिः, कुतूहलम्, भाण्डागारः and शीलम् together endorse a way of life built on:

- (A) Boasting, laziness, hoarded wealth, and pride
- (B) Silence, idleness, luck, and indifference
- (C) Harsh speech, greed, secrecy, and impossibility
- (D) Wise speech, curiosity, treasured knowledge, and good character

46. The poet chose दुर्लभम् over अशक्यम् deliberately. Which student attitude does that single lexical choice most directly cultivate?

- (A) Resignation — impossible goals should simply be abandoned
- (B) Complacency — common goals need no effort at all

- (C) Indifference — speech does not really matter
- (D) Persistence — rare goals reward steady, patient effort

47. Apply the verse to leadership: a manager must deliver a hard truth to an underperforming team. Which approach best realises हितं मनोहारि च, and why does each rejected one fail a specific half?

- (A) State the true problem clearly but frame it with respect and encouragement — useful (हितम्) and pleasing (मनोहारि) together
- (B) Soften it into vague praise that hides the problem — pleasing but not useful
- (C) Deliver a blunt, humiliating dressing-down — useful but not pleasing
- (D) Say nothing and hope it improves — neither useful nor pleasing

48. A pupil reasons: 'Since both हितम् and मनोहारि describe वचः, they must mean the same thing, the way two adjectives on one noun usually overlap.' The flaw in this is that:

- (A) Adjectives on the same noun must always be synonyms, so the pupil is right
- (B) Two adjectives on one noun can name distinct, independent properties; here usefulness and pleasantness are different qualities, which is exactly why having both is rare
- (C) हितम् and मनोहारि are indeed synonyms, both meaning 'pleasing'
- (D) Only one adjective can attach to a noun, so one of them is ungrammatical

49. Mapping the verse's structure: of its four key words, exactly three are qualifiers and one is the thing qualified. Which assignment is correct?

- (A) वचः is the qualified noun; हितम्, मनोहारि and दुर्लभम् are its three qualifiers
- (B) दुर्लभम् is the noun; वचः, हितम् and मनोहारि qualify it
- (C) हितम् is the noun; वचः, मनोहारि and दुर्लभम् qualify it
- (D) All four are co-equal nouns with no qualifier among them

50. Why does it strengthen the verse's moral force that दुर्लभम् is grouped as a property OF the both-and speech, rather than as a separate independent claim that 'speech is rare'?

- (A) It makes no difference; 'rare' attaches to nothing in particular either way
- (B) It weakens the verse, since attaching rarity to a quality is grammatically impossible
- (C) It changes दुर्लभम् into a verb meaning 'to make rare'
- (D) Tying rarity specifically to the both-and quality says the difficulty lies in combining usefulness with pleasantness — pinpointing exactly what is hard, not vaguely calling all speech rare

51. Synthesise the chapter's two clusters — the speech-cluster (हितम्/मनोहारि/दुर्लभम्/वचः) and the effort-cluster (क्षणशः/कणशः/क्रियावान्/विकल्थन). The single value that threads through BOTH clusters is:

- (A) Eloquence and boasting are the highest goods in both clusters
- (B) Instant results without effort are praised throughout

(C) Substance earned through effort triumphs over easy or empty alternatives — genuine, hard-won good over show

(D) The two clusters share no value and pull in opposite directions

52. An aphorism states: 'Let your work speak louder than your words.' Which chapter teaching does it most directly distil?

(A) The विद्या-क्षणशः pairing — learn moment by moment

(B) The सूक्तिः vs सूक्ष्म distinction — a saying versus the subtle

(C) The praise of the क्रियावान् over the विकृत्यन — deeds over boasting

(D) The दुर्लभम् vs अशक्यम् contrast — rare versus impossible

53. Consider speech that is true and beneficial (हितम्) but deliberately blunt and wounding. A student calls it 'the verse's ideal because the truth always pleases.' Correct him precisely.

(A) He is right: any true statement is automatically both useful and pleasing

(B) It is मनोहारि but not हितम्, so it fails the usefulness half

(C) It is neither हितम् nor मनोहारि, so it is wholly outside the verse

(D) It is हितम् but not मनोहारि, so it meets only one half; the verse's ideal requires the pleasing quality too, and truth does not automatically please

54. Why might a flattering compliment fail the verse's standard even though it is highly मनोहारि (pleasing)?

(A) If it is untrue or unhelpful it lacks हितम्, and the verse demands BOTH, so pleasantness alone is not enough

(B) It cannot fail, since pleasing speech automatically satisfies the whole verse

(C) It fails because मनोहारि speech is itself condemned by the verse

(D) It fails only because flattery is grammatically incorrect Sanskrit

55. Generalising beyond speech: the chapter's logic of 'both qualities at once is rare' would predict that, in any domain, an item meeting two demanding independent criteria is:

(A) Rarer than an item meeting either single criterion, because the qualifying set is the smaller intersection

(B) More common, because two criteria give it two ways to qualify

(C) Exactly as common as meeting just one criterion

(D) Impossible, because no item can meet two criteria at once

56. The single best one-sentence restatement of हितं मनोहारि च दुर्लभं वचः, capturing every nuance the chapter stresses, is:

(A) Speech that is either beneficial or pleasing is easy to find everywhere

(B) Beneficial speech can never be produced, so one should not try

(C) Pleasing speech is always harmful and should be avoided

(D) Speech that is at once beneficial (हितम्) AND pleasing (मनोहारि) is rare (दुर्लभम्) — yet, being merely rare and not impossible, it is worth striving for

57. If you had to compress the chapter's entire ethic into one rule of conduct, the most faithful is:

- (A) Speak loudly, get rich fast, boast of your deeds, and ignore character
- (B) Stay silent, avoid effort, and trust to luck for everything
- (C) Value pleasing speech alone and disregard usefulness and conduct
- (D) Speak words both useful and pleasing, gather knowledge and wealth patiently bit by bit, act rather than boast, and let good character guide all

58. दुर्लभम् carries the prefix दुर्-. Comparing दुर्लभम् ('hard to obtain') with a word like दुर्गमम् ('hard to traverse'), the consistent contribution of दुर्- across such words is:

- (A) 'Difficult / hard to do', attaching the sense of difficulty to whatever action the base names
- (B) 'Twice', doubling the action of the base
- (C) 'Good / well', commending the action of the base
- (D) 'Away', reversing the direction of the base

59. Imagine extending the verse's pattern to a fresh line: 'सत्यं प्रियं च दुर्लभं वचः.' Holding the grammar of the original fixed, सत्यम् and प्रियम् would here function as:

- (A) Two nouns naming separate things, with च meaning 'or' between them
- (B) Two more neuter-singular adjectives, joined by च, qualifying the same neuter वचः
- (C) Two adverbs modifying दुर्लभम् rather than वचः
- (D) A subject (सत्यम्) and its verb (प्रियम्), with वचः as object

60. A reviewer claims the verse is 'about grammar, not ethics, since it only describes a kind of speech.' The strongest reply is that:

- (A) The reply fails: a description of speech can carry no ethical weight at all
- (B) The verse is purely grammatical, since वचः is a noun being parsed
- (C) The verse is purely about wealth, since दुर्लभम् refers to scarce goods
- (D) By calling beneficial-and-pleasing speech rare-but-attainable, the verse implicitly urges us to cultivate such speech — describing an ideal carries a quiet prescription to pursue it

Solutions — Sanskrit (Class 7), Chapter 8: हितं मनोहारि च दुर्लभं वचः (Hitam Manohari cha Durlabham Vachah) — Paper 4

Paper 4 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	D	11	D	21	D	31	D	41	A	51	C
2	B	12	B	22	B	32	B	42	B	52	C
3	C	13	B	23	C	33	A	43	C	53	D
4	A	14	C	24	D	34	A	44	A	54	A
5	D	15	B	25	B	35	B	45	D	55	A
6	A	16	B	26	C	36	A	46	D	56	D
7	C	17	B	27	A	37	D	47	A	57	D
8	C	18	C	28	C	38	B	48	B	58	A
9	A	19	A	29	B	39	C	49	A	59	B
10	C	20	D	30	C	40	C	50	D	60	D

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (D) Because च conjoins the two adjectives, the verse points to the intersection of useful-speech and pleasing-speech — the one cell where both are true at once — and calls only that combination rare. It does not speak of speech in general, nor of the merely-one-quality cases, nor of the speech that is neither.

2. (B) A conjunction demands that both conditions hold; a disjunction is satisfied by either condition alone. Swapping the 'and' for an 'or' therefore drops the demand from two simultaneous qualities to a single one — loosening, not tightening or erasing, the standard.

3. (C) The line has one substantive, वचः, and the other three forms qualify it — they share its neuter singular and so behave as predicate adjectives. Reading them as separate nouns, as verbs, or as adverbs all misses the single-subject-with-three-attributes structure.

4. (A) Sanskrit adjectives agree with their noun in gender, number and case; matching the neuter singular वचः forces neuter singular qualifiers. Were the noun masculine, the qualifiers would shift to masculine. They are not gender-frozen, not pluralised by their own count, and they remain adjectives.

5. (D) The ideal demands usefulness and pleasantness together. The sweet lie pleases but does not benefit (and is untrue); the harsh rebuke benefits but does not please; silence is neither. Only the true, kind, helpful correction satisfies both halves at once.

6. (A) दुर्लभम् sits between 'easy to get' and 'cannot be got': it means rare and hard, yet reachable with effort. The verse therefore does not place ideal speech among the common, nor at the impossible extreme, nor off any frequency scale.

7. (C) दुर्- signals difficulty, the contrary of सु- ('easy'); it negates ease, not possibility. अशक्यम् negates possibility outright. So 'hard to obtain' is a softer claim than 'cannot be obtained' — not its synonym, not its opposite, and certainly not stronger than impossibility.

8. (C) A goal worth striving for must be attainable; दुर्लभ keeps it attainable-though-rare, so persistence makes sense. अशक्यम् declares it unattainable, which guts the exhortation to persist. The two words are not interchangeable, दुर्लभ does not mean common, and an impossible goal cannot justify effort.

9. (A) The first member is मनः (मनस्); before the voiced ह the visarga turns to the 'o' vowel, yielding मनो-, joined to हारि ('stealing/captivating'). It is not मन + अहारि, not मनः + आहारि, and the स्/visarga does change — so 'mind-feeding' and 'not-stealing' are both wrong resolutions.

10. (C) हारि here is 'one who steals/captivates', so the compound literally 'steals the heart' — i.e. delights and pleases. It does not mean harming, instructing, or hiding; those readings confuse हारि with unrelated senses.

11. (D) हितम् is about benefit to one's welfare; मनोहारि (heart-stealing) is about appeal to one's feelings. So usefulness targets welfare and pleasantness targets the heart — not the reverse, and neither concerns wealth or character here.

12. (B) सत्य means 'true' and its negative अनृत means 'untrue/false'. हित is 'beneficial' and प्रिय is 'pleasing/dear' — so the option swapping हित with प्रिय is wrong, as are the options that tie truth-words to pleasing/benefit.

13. (B) प्रियम् ('dear/pleasing') overlaps with मनोहारि ('heart-stealing'), since both pick out the agreeable, heart-winning side of speech. It is not the useful side (हितम्), not rarity (दुर्लभम्), and not speech itself (वचः).

- 14. (C)** Vowel-sandhi needs a vowel ending meeting a vowel beginning; च opens with the consonant च्, so no such merger arises and the particle is simply written after. च is not a verb, मनोहारि ends in a vowel (not a consonant), and the explanation has nothing to do with emphasis.
- 15. (B)** An enclitic च placed after a word ties that word back to the preceding one, so मनोहारि च links 'pleasing' with the earlier 'useful'. It does not bind the later वचः/दुर्लभम् pair, does not attach only forward, and is not meaningless.
- 16. (B)** वा is the disjunctive 'or', so replacing च would relax the conjunction to an alternative. वा is not another 'and', not the interrogative किम्/का, and not a negation.
- 17. (B)** The verse predicts rarity from the both-and quality, not the reverse; affirming the consequent (rare $\Rightarrow$ both) is a fallacy, since many things may be rare for other reasons. So rarity alone licenses neither 'it is both' nor 'it is neither' nor 'it is common'.
- 18. (C)** The subject is not bare वचः but वचः qualified as both useful and pleasing; rarity attaches only to that qualified subject. The pupil drops the qualifiers and over-generalises. दुर्लभम् does not mean 'all', and the restriction comes from the adjectives, not from वचः itself.
- 19. (A)** वा drops the demand to a single quality, and सुलभम् ('easy to get') replaces 'rare' with 'common'. Both edits loosen the claim. वा and च are not synonyms, nor are सुलभ and दुर्लभ, so neither 'unchanged' nor a split effect fits.
- 20. (D)** Negating the 'pleasing' half leaves speech that helps yet grates; lacking one of the two required qualities, it fails the both-and ideal. It is neither 'pleasing but useless', nor still 'both', nor 'neither'.
- 21. (D)** -शस् makes 'by units of' distributive adverbs, and adverbs are indeclinable — invariant across gender, number and case. They are not datives, not agreeing adjectives, and not conjugating verbs.
- 22. (B)** क्षणशः ('moment by moment') fits the time-based growth of learning; कणशः ('grain by grain') fits the unit-by-unit saving of wealth. The match is principled, so the adverbs are not freely swappable, are not literal descriptions of each noun's substance, and do not mean the same thing.
- 23. (C)** बिन्दु + -शस् mirrors क्षण/कण + -शस्, giving a 'drop by drop' distributive adverb that does not decline. It is not a dative noun, not a verb form, and not an agreeing adjective.
- 24. (D)** Daily moments of study are units of time, matching क्षणशः ('moment by moment'). कणशः belongs to grain/coin accumulation, the growth was incremental rather than instantaneous, and these distributive adverbs are precisely meant to describe such gradual processes.

25. (B) -वान् adds 'possessing', and क्रिया (from कृ, 'to do') is real action, so क्रियावान् is a possessor-of-action, a doer. The suffix is not privative (so not 'idle'), the word concerns doing not merely describing, and -वान् does not mean 'opposing'.

26. (C) The praised doer embodies action; the criticised boaster embodies empty talk, so the chapter prizes deeds over talk. It is not the reverse, not a wealth-over-knowledge claim, and not a counsel of total silence.

27. (A) The doer is the one whose completed action speaks for itself, namely the quiet finisher; the boaster is the one whose talk outruns his unfinished deeds, namely the loud announcer. Confident announcement is not doing, producing work does not make one a boaster, and describing work aloud is not the mark of a doer.

28. (C) The two teachings share one spine — value substance over show. Good speech must really help and please (not merely sound nice), just as a worthy person must really do (not merely boast). They neither contradict, since the verse never prizes empty talk, nor are they unrelated or jointly pro-silence.

29. (B) Two similar simple vowels (उ + उ) coalesce into the corresponding long vowel ऊ, so सु + उक्तिः → सूक्तिः. They do not yield the diphthong ओ, do not become the semivowel वृ, and do not stay separated.

30. (C) Only सूक्तिः embeds उक्ति, anchoring it to 'saying'; सूक्ष्म lacks that element and means 'subtle/fine'. So they are not both speech-words, सूक्ष्म is not a kind of saying, and a shared opening syllable does not make synonyms.

31. (D) Like सु+उक्ति, सुभाषितम् is सु ('well') + भाषितम् ('spoken'), i.e. a well-spoken saying — matching सूक्तिः. It is not 'six faults', not 'hidden light', and not merely a proper name.

32. (B) कुतूहलम्, कौतुकम् and जिज्ञासा all name curiosity, the desire to learn, which the chapter treats as the engine of knowledge. They concern neither boasting, nor rest, nor greed for wealth.

33. (A) Both a storehouse and क्षणशः-knowledge grow by incremental additions over time, so the metaphor fits the gradual gathering of learning. A storehouse does not fill instantly, the metaphor is meant earnestly (not ironic about coins), and it is not an emptiness image.

34. (A) Eloquence, useful advice and riches are outward gifts; dishonesty shows the inner deficiency the chapter prizes most — शीलम्. He plainly has speech and wealth, and curiosity is not the relevant lack.

35. (B) Ideal speech is दुर्लभम् (rare-but-reachable) and knowledge/wealth grow bit by bit, so both verses point to patient, incremental effort toward hard-but-attainable goods. They are not easy/instant, not impossible, and not won by boasting.

36. (A) The two words differ in force: difficulty versus impossibility. The verse's choice of दुर्लभम् keeps the goal reachable, refuting the 'never exist' claim. दुर्लभम् is not 'impossible', अशक्यम् is not 'rare', and the verse does use दुर्लभम्.

37. (D) Matching neuter singular वचः requires the neuter singular हितम्. The masculine हितः and feminine हिता disagree in gender, and a plural हितानि disagrees in number — the count of separate qualities does not pluralise an adjective bound to one noun.

38. (B) वचः is a neuter sibilant (-स्) stem, parallel to मनस् → मनः; the visarga is the stem-final -स् at word end. It is neither a feminine -आ stem, nor a masculine -अ stem, nor an indeclinable.

39. (C) मनः in मनोहारि is the same -स् stem as वचः/मनस्, and its visarga turns to 'o' before the voiced ह. क्रियावान्'s -वान् is a possessive suffix, दुर्- is a prefix, and क्षणशः's -शः is the distributive -शस् suffix — none are neuter -स् noun stems.

40. (C) सु+उक्ति is a 'well-spoken saying', so a सूक्तिः is a pithy maxim. It is not a boast (विकथन), not a storehouse inventory (भाण्डागारः), and not a meaningless subtle riddle (a confusion with सूक्ष्म).

41. (A) Eager questioning and seeking answers is curiosity, कुतूहलम्. Asking aloud is not boasting, her questions are answerable (not अशक्यम्), and she herself is a curious learner, not a 'storehouse'.

42. (B) दुर्लभम् is 'rare', च is 'and', क्रियावान् is 'doer', सूक्तिः is 'good saying' — all four right. The other sets each smuggle in at least one classic error: 'impossible/or/boaster/subtle', 'common', or 'or/boaster'.

43. (C) Knowledge is gathered moment by moment (क्षणशः) and wealth grain by grain (कणशः); the adverbs must not swap and must not collapse to one. The other three options either reverse the pair or wrongly use a single adverb for both.

44. (A) च is 'and', दुर्लभम् is 'rare' not impossible, क्रियावान् is a doer not a talker, and क्षणशः/कणशः are distributive 'unit by unit' adverbs, not 'all at once' — every one of the four is mistaken.

45. (D) सूक्तिः (wise saying), कुतूहलम् (curiosity), भाण्डागारः (treasured store of knowledge) and शीलम् (character) map onto wise speech, curiosity, valued learning and good character. The negative lists reverse the chapter's values.

46. (D) Calling the ideal rare-but-reachable invites perseverance toward it. अशक्यम् would invite giving up (resignation), 'common' would invite complacency, and neither word implies that speech is unimportant.

- 47. (A)** Only the respectful-yet-honest approach satisfies both halves. Vague praise drops the हितम् (no real benefit), the humiliating rebuke drops the मनोहारि (no pleasantness), and silence drops both.
- 48. (B)** Multiple adjectives commonly add separate information, and here 'beneficial' and 'pleasing' are genuinely different — their rare co-occurrence is the verse's whole point. They are not forced synonyms, not both 'pleasing', and a noun may take several adjectives.
- 49. (A)** वचः ('speech') is the substantive; the other three describe it (useful, pleasing, rare). दुर्लभम् and हितम् are adjectives, not the head noun, and the line is not four parallel nouns.
- 50. (D)** By predicating rarity of the qualified speech, the verse locates the difficulty precisely in fusing the two qualities, which is a sharper and more useful claim than a blanket 'speech is rare'. The attachment is grammatical, meaningful, and does not turn दुर्लभम् into a verb.
- 51. (C)** Both clusters elevate the harder, genuine good — speech that truly helps and pleases, and learning/wealth/deeds patiently earned — over the cheap or hollow option. They do not exalt boasting or instant ease, and they are unified, not opposed.
- 52. (C)** Letting action outshine talk is exactly the doer-over-boaster lesson (कर्म over कथन). It is not about incremental learning, not the साइंग-versus-subtle vocabulary point, and not the rarity-versus-impossibility distinction.
- 53. (D)** Blunt, wounding truth helps (हितम्) yet does not please (not मनोहारि), satisfying only one of the two demands — so it is not the ideal, and truth is not inherently pleasing. It is not the reverse (it is useful), and not 'neither' (it is useful).
- 54. (A)** Flattery may delight (मनोहारि) yet, lacking truth or benefit, it misses हितम्; the both-and standard rejects it. Pleasantness is not by itself sufficient, मनोहारि is not condemned (it is half the ideal), and the issue is ethical, not grammatical.
- 55. (A)** Requiring both criteria narrows the field to their intersection, which is smaller than either single set — so such items are rarer, matching the verse's दुर्लभम्. They are not more common, not equally common, and not impossible (दुर्लभम्, not अशक्यम्).
- 56. (D)** The faithful restatement keeps the conjunction (both), the correct sense of दुर्लभम् (rare-but-attainable), and the implied encouragement to strive. The distractors variously swap 'and' for 'or', make सुलभम् of दुर्लभम्, declare impossibility, or condemn pleasing speech.
- 57. (D)** The chapter weaves together both-and speech, patient accumulation (क्षणशः/कणशः), deeds over boasting (क्रियावान्/विकृत्यन), and शीलम् as the crowning value — exactly the first option. The others invert one or more of these.

58. (A) दुर्- adds difficulty: hard-to-obtain, hard-to-traverse, and so on, modifying the base's action with 'hard'. It is not a doubling prefix, not the laudatory सु-, and not a directional 'away'.

59. (B) Mirroring हितं मनोहारि च, the new line would have सत्यम् and प्रियम् as neuter-singular adjectives conjoined by च ('and') and agreeing with वचः. They would not be 'or'-linked nouns, not adverbs on दुर्लभम्, and not a subject-verb pair.

60. (D) Naming the both-and speech as a rare yet reachable ideal frames it as something worth striving for, which is an ethical nudge, not mere parsing. The verse is not value-neutral description, not a grammar exercise, and not about wealth.